

Stop Your PC Speaker From Beeping

Speakers will beep and they will beep every time there's an error or alert that occurs. These can be very disturbing to the user and others around. The speaker can be turned by a simple command that you can type in a terminal or at the console—`modprobe pcspkr`. Should you decide that you need the speaker again, you can turn it back on by entering `rmmod pcspkr`.

Using Better Smoothing

Like Windows, where LCD users choose ClearType fonts for LCDs, Linux too has a font smoothing option that can be used. Go to **Start > Preferences > Appearance**. Click the **Fonts** tab on the top and select the **Subpixel Smoothing fonts** on the bottom-right. Click **OK**. More advanced settings for the font smoothing can be changed by clicking on the **Details** button.

Moving The Mouse Cursor Using The Keyboard

There are those rare occasions when your mouse is not detected or stops responding. You can use the Num pad on the keyboard in Ubuntu, to move your mouse around. Press the **[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Num]** Lock keys to enable this mode. Now use the direction keys on the Num pad to move the mouse pointer. Use the **+** sign to single click, **0** to right click and **[Enter]** to execute a program. Press **[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Num Lock]** again to disable it.

Restarting X And Killing Applications

If due to any changes that you make or any stability issues that you maybe facing, restart the X server. A quick way to do this is to press **[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Backspace]**.

Delete Files Permanently

Nautilus sends all deleted files to the Trash by default. Pressing the **[Del]** key normally sends files to the Trash. To permanently delete files, bypassing the Trash, the best way is to hold the **[Shift]** key and then press the **[Del]** key or right click on the file and select **Delete**. If the option isn't available, start Nautilus. Go to **Edit > Preferences > Behavior**. Make sure the box for **Include a Delete command that bypasses Trash** is enabled. Click **Close**.

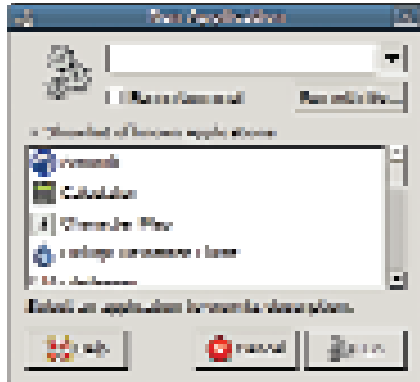
Switching Virtual Desktops Quickly

Linux distributions have had virtual desktop from a very long time. They are useful to categorise and use each

desktop for a different task. That way you can have all your messengers in one window, browser windows in another and so on. The quickest way to switch virtual desktops is to hold down **[Ctrl] + [Alt] + left arrow** or **right arrow**. The left arrow takes you to the previous desktop and the right arrow takes you to the next. You can also move applications from one workspace to another by right clicking on the titlebar of the application, choosing **Move to Another Workspace** and then selecting the workspace.

Quick Run Applications

Windows users know the **[Windows] + [R]** shortcut all too well. It's a quick way to run applications but Linux Mint and Ubuntu Linux users have a similar feature they can use. Hold down **[Alt] + [F2]**. Here you can type in the name of an application or location of a folder. You can also choose



The Run Application box allows applications to be executed quickly

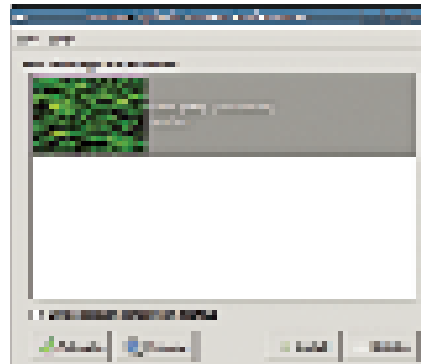
from a list of applications to run. Click on **[Show list of known applications]** and you can choose one of the many installed applications to run.

Viewing Folder Trees

In Nautilus, files are displayed like in any other file manager. Nautilus has an option where all the sub-folders and the files can be displayed as a tree something similar to what Windows Explorer does to machines on a network. First, change the view mode to details by clicking on **View > View as List** or by pressing **[Ctrl] + [2]**. To open up a tree, click on the triangle on the left of the folder.

Installing A Splash Screen

A custom splash screen can be used where all the different modules load when you log into X. For this, you can do things the hard way but the simplest way to download a tiny application called `gnome-splashscreen-manager`.

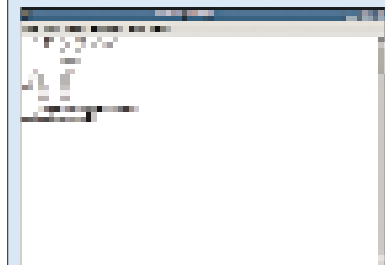


gnome-splashscreen-manager lets you set a custom splash screen

Easter Eggs

The Book of Mozilla!

Firefox like any other browser has the **[about: address]** that can be entered. For example, **[about:config]** loads up the advanced preferences windows where values for all the variables in Firefox can be accessed. Enter **[about:mozilla]** and you will see an extract from "The Book of Mozilla". The entire list of extracts can be viewed at www.mozilla.org/book/



apt-get's ASCII cow

Aptitude Easter Eggs

Aptitude is an easy interface for package management. There are a few Easter eggs hidden inside aptitude. **[apt-get moo]** should give you a funny little cow as ASCII art. Next, try **[aptitude moo]**, then try **[aptitude -v moo]**. Keep adding an additional **[v]** to the earlier parameter and you'll get a funny sequence of messages.

Something fishy about Gnome

Gnome has an Easter egg, which is a fish that swims about on the screen. The only way you can actually see it, is by pressing **[Alt] + [F2]** to get the **[Run Application window]**. Enter **in**, free the fish and click **[Run]**. A small fish will appear from one corner of the window, making its way to the other side. Click on it and it will dash back again from where it came.

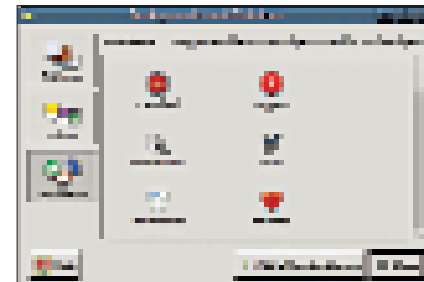
Start up the Package Manager through the **Start** button. Search for `gnome-splashscreen-manager` using the **Search** button. Check the box for it and choose to install the application. Any dependencies required can be downloaded too. When installed, press **[Alt] + [F2]**. Enter `gnome-splashscreen-manager`. Click on the **Install** button and browse and select the image that you want to use as your splash screen. Click **Activate** after choosing the splash screen of your choice.

Autocomplete Search In Terminal Or Console

A complete history of all the commands is stored in a file in your home directory called `.bash_history`. Linux already has `autocomplete` that you can use by pressing the **[Tab]** key while entering a command. A more useful feature is the **find** feature, which gives you the closest search result from the history. That way, you can type large commands that you normally wouldn't remember. To use this feature, press **[Ctrl] + [R]** and then start typing the command. As you type, the closest result from your history will be displayed. Press **[Enter]** when you have the right command.

Adding Visual Tags To Folders In Nautilus

Nautilus allows you to tag folders or files using artwork called emblems. Start



Tags can be added to any file or folder by a simple drag and drop action

Nautilus and go to **Edit > Backgrounds and Emblems**. Click on the **Emblems** button and then drag and drop emblems from the list to a file or folder of your choice.

You can also import your own custom emblems by clicking on **Add a New Emblem**. Enter a new keyword and click on the **Image** button. Choose from one of the existing images or click on **Browse** to select a different image. Click **OK**.

DELUGE

Deluge is a BitTorrent client that runs on Windows, Linux and MacOS X. It's not as small as `µTorrent` (which Windows users adore) but it still has loads of features and

more importantly, support for plug-ins. We're using the latest 0.5.8.6 version on Windows and we're looking for some of its features that can come handy while migrating to it and some others that match the features in other clients.

Getting Deluge On Linux

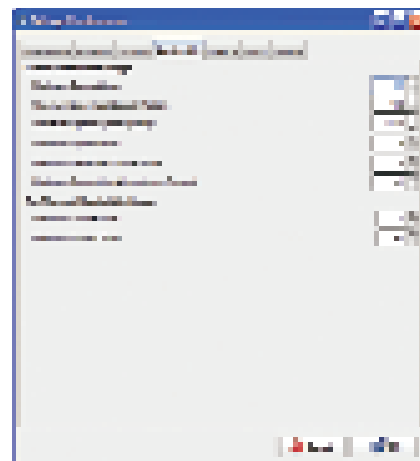
Deluge most likely doesn't come installed with the distribution so you'll have to download it. You can download it from www.deluge-torrent.org. If you're on Linux search for Deluge using a package manager such as the Synaptic Package Manager. Check the box and click on **Mark** for installation. Click on **Apply** to have it downloaded and installed.

Running Deluge In The System Tray

Deluge like other applications such as download managers, instant messenger and BitTorrent clients can be run in the system tray all the time. To enable or customize the way Deluge runs in the tray, click on **Edit > Preferences**. Click on the **Other** tab and make sure the checkbox for **Enable system tray icon** is enabled. Clicking on the **Start in Tray** checkbox will put Deluge in the system tray when you initialize it. You can even assign a password to make sure no one else can open Deluge. Click the **Password protect system tray** checkbox and enter a password. Click **OK** to save the changes.

Tweaking Connection Settings For Your Speed

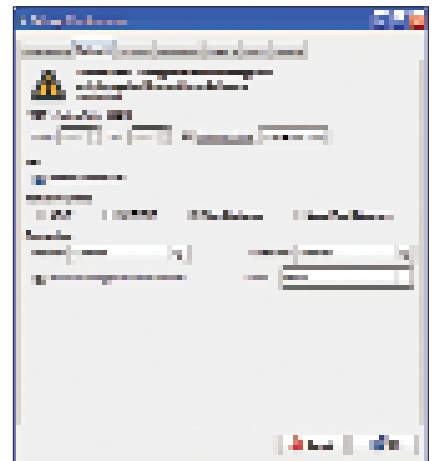
BitTorrent clients need to be tweaked and set up right or you end up with very bad speeds. Upload speeds need to be high as well, to get a proportionate download speed. Click on **Edit > Preferences** and then on the **Bandwidth** tab. Here, you can make changes to the number of connections being made by your BitTorrent client.



Tags can be added to any file or folder by a simple drag and drop action

You can also set the number of simultaneous downloads. If all this is rather confusing, you can also use the wizard which asks you for your connection upload speed and sets all the other parameters for you. Go back to the main Deluge interface and click on **Help > Run Configuration Wizard**.

ISPs can also try and throttle down BitTorrent clients and every single BitTorrent client has been implementing features to try and bypass this. Deluge too has an encryption feature that can be enabled by clicking on the **Network** tab under **Preferences**. Select the dropdown menus for **Encryption for Inbound** and **Outbound** as **Enabled**. If your ISP blocks certain BitTorrent ports, making changes to the default port range of 6881 to 6889 to something else can help too. Clicking **[Random Ports]** will set a random port every time Deluge is run. If you want to check if the port is open and accessible from the Internet, click the **Test Active Port** button. A page with the result appears. Click **OK** and restart Deluge.



Other than setting the connection speed and ports for your connection, enabling encryption can also help achieve higher speeds

Downloading Select Files

When a torrent contains a folder or multiple files, you'll notice that you aren't able to select just a few files for downloading like you would in other clients such as `µTorrent`. To select specific files, click on **Edit > Preferences > Downloads**. Leave the checkbox for **Enable selecting files for torrents before loading checked**.

Automatically Download Torrents

Deluge can automatically download torrents that have been put into a folder—you need not open every single torrent to make Deluge download it. To enable this feature, first create a folder where all your torrents will be placed. Click on **Edit > Preferences > Downloads**.